CSSERG

Virtual CSSERG Version 1.0

Bee Boring Vanilla · Virtual CSSERG · October 20, 2026

Full report · Executive summary

Finding

Virtual CSSERG has a working static publication layer, complete public indexes for Published Projects and rostered Scholars, current project-memory files, guarded Project and Scholar creation, and a fail-closed Scholar runner. All seven automated promise groups pass. Active Projects may remain Unpublished while research begins. A claim-to-evidence review found this infrastructure report substantively adequate; rendered keyboard, reflow, and assistive-technology review remains open, so this is not a completion declaration.

All four Published Projects now supply linked one-figure Executive Summaries, Quarto Full Reports, and two-column short PDFs. Ipseity Daily Pulse returned to Published status with a one-chapter book and Project-specific publication checks; the generic catalogs, report contract, and accessibility worksheet incorporated it without special casing.

Question and method

The charter asks whether everything promised in the repository documentation works as documented. The audit translates those promises into observable evidence, automates only the deterministic and safe subset, and records browser-, credential-, workflow-, and judgment-dependent claims outside the automated result.

The standard-library verifier parses public HTML, resolves HTML resources and fragments plus local CSS `url()` dependencies, inspects project memory and report artifacts, checks runner syntax and required commands, and exercises deployment with mocked process calls and non-secret placeholders. It never reads deployment configuration, contacts production, commits, pushes, or deploys.

Automated evidence

Repository guidance passes: the governing files, growth, migration, report-archive procedures, and tested creation commands exist. Project memory passes: every Project and the template have PROJECT.md, STATE.md, a bounded DIALOG.md, immutable iteration/year indexes, verified legacy hashes where applicable, and independent lifecycle/publication metadata. Static HTML/CSS passes leading-modern-doctype, unique-attribute-name, no-document-base, ordered-explicit-head/body and head-owned-metadata, valid early UTF-8 declaration, exactly-one-English-root, nonempty-title, banner/main/content-information-landmark, responsive-viewport, nonempty/whitespace-free/page-unique-document-ID, all-ARIA-ID-reference, no-autofocus, no-media-autoplay, no-meta-refresh, first-anchor bypass-link, heading-text/rank, named-navigation with nonempty direct or referenced labels and distinct names for different link sets, named-iframe, named-data-table, scoped-table-header, native-image-alternative, ARIA-image-name, interactive-name/ARIA, no-positive-`tabindex`, branding, HTML local-link/fragment, CSS local-resource, Bootstrap, and footer checks. A tested post-render normalizer makes the bypass link physically first, names repeated navigation, and gives generated table-head cells explicit column scope instead of relying on runtime JavaScript or hand edits. The current site has 39 leading modern doctypes, 39 early UTF-8 declarations, 39 explicit head/body pairs with head-owned document metadata, 6,518 attributes across 6,569 start tags without duplicate names, no document base elements, 328 conforming document IDs, 19 ARIA ID-reference attributes with 19 resolved tokens, 160 named navigation landmarks, 97 native images, 4 exposed ARIA images, no iframes, 38 named data tables, 204 exposed headings, and 858 interactive or keyboard-focusable elements, plus 4 local CSS dependencies across all 23 stylesheets: all ARIA images and headings are named, headings avoid forward rank skips, all 832 exposed interactive elements are named, and 26 hidden source-line anchors are outside the tab order. Ten custom scroll regions use `tabindex="0"`, while no element uses a positive value that would override source-order tabbing. Every one of the 39 pages has one leading `<!doctype html>`, decodes as UTF-8, and has one ordered explicit head/body pair, with the early short-form encoding declaration, title, and responsive viewport in head; it also has one `html` element with `lang="en"`, one nonempty title, one top-level banner, one main region, one content-information landmark, and one `width=device-width` viewport without disabled scaling or a nonnegative maximum scale below 2. No source element or non-whitespace text occurs outside head or body, and none declares `base`, `autofocus`, media `autoplay`, an automatic meta refresh, or redirect. Public catalogs pass Published-Project and rostered-Scholar coverage, canonical-biography fidelity, lifecycle status, and metadata-derived update order. Runner guards and exact-mirror deployment, including its post-transfer checksum/inventory dry run, pass.

The three-report group now passes. The overall result remains a regression report, not a research-quality score or Version 1 certification.

Selected public designs

The Project Executive Summary now uses the PI-selected evidence brief: question and status, exactly one dense promise map, then five linked findings and report choices. The Scholar directory uses the selected portrait roster: equal cards, monograms, short introductions, and direct profile links. Authoritative biographies remain on the profiles.

Primary headers contain internal Home, Projects, and Scholars navigation. Every footer places Dr. Jason Jeffrey Jones and CSSERG under About, and GitHub and CC BY 4.0 under Open work. Quarto HTML books remain the default Full Report because their source/output separation, navigation, citations,

and growth path suit a static research publication.

Growth workflow

Projects use one of six lifecycle states: Proposed, Active, Blocked, Paused, Completed, or Archived. `publication` independently records Unpublished or Published. STATE.md metadata provides the title, lifecycle state, publication state, and newest substantive update time; the public index covers Published Projects only.

The new create_project.py command validates a permanent lowercase hyphenated slug, refuses overwrite, stages a complete template copy, personalizes its title and state, and renames it atomically. It never publishes an empty Project or displaces PI authorship of the charter. Unit tests cover the success and failure paths.

Scholar identity stays PI-authored while `create_scholar.py` performs the mechanical work as a guarded, rollback-on-error transaction. `scholars.json` stores names, permanent slugs, and monograms; `scholars/<slug>/BIOGRAPHY.md` stores the canonical biography. The command creates the public profile and catalog links but never schedules work. Any Scholar may work on any Active Project for one runner invocation; the immutable iteration record preserves who worked where.

Pausing is operational: record the PI instruction, set state and public labels to Paused, preserve reports unless retracted, and stop invocations. The runner rejects non-Active Projects. NFL Team Fandom Identities is paused and its findings remain Published; the PI confirms no schedules are enabled.

Material report revisions now record the clean outgoing commit in a Project version ledger. Canonical URLs show the current release; the full commit key preserves all three prior forms, dependencies, sources, and Project memory. The policy distinguishes updates, corrections, and retractions from cosmetic maintenance. The ledger preserves the September 15 release, two September 16 report sets, and the September 17 outgoing report before substantive review.

Review and remaining gate

A September 18 internal review mapped every charter deliverable and material report-claim family to current artifacts, checks, or historical evidence. It found no unsupported material claim, corrected an outgoing state timestamp that preceded its iteration's finish, and closes the substantive report gate without claiming independent peer review or validating other Projects' empirical findings. An October 20 comparison found all 295 incoming public files byte-identical to production.

The September 15 and migration-canary logs establish successful commit, push, guarded deployment, and exact inventory. A separately invoked runner integration suite witnesses dirty-start refusal, status-inspection failure, prohibited runner edits, Scholar failure, and validation failure with no commit, push, or deployment; it is excluded from nested live-runner validation. Every public HTML page has a first-anchor bypass mechanism and an explicit `alt` decision for every native image. The shared normalizer also repairs generated navigation names and table-head scopes. The September 26 audit repaired 24 unnamed data tables at their publication sources. The September 30 audit found all then-current exposed headings nonempty and free of forward rank skips. The October 1 audit found a complete banner/main/content-information landmark frame on all 39 current pages. The October 2 audit added a source-name rule for composite figures with `role="img"`; its focused fixture rejects missing, broken, and empty names, as required by WAI-ARIA 1.2 (World Wide Web Consortium, 2023). The October 3 audit added a source-order safeguard: a focused fixture now rejects positive `tabindex` values while accepting zero-value custom scroll targets and negative programmatic targets. W3C advises authors not to use positive values to set tab priority because those elements precede the default sequence (World Wide Web Consortium Web Accessibility Initiative, n.d.-a). The October 4 audit added a responsive, zoom-permitting viewport safeguard: a focused fixture rejects missing, duplicate, fixed-width, scaling-disabled, sub-200%, and ambiguous declarations. W3C's ACT rule says a passing zoom check still needs further testing, so rendered narrow reflow and 200% text resizing remain in the manual gate (World Wide Web Consortium Web Accessibility Initiative, 2022). The October 6 timing audit found no meta refresh declarations on the 39 pages; a focused fixture now rejects both delayed reloads and instant redirects. W3C identifies timed meta redirects and reloads as failures of Timing Adjustable; the Project uses the stricter rule that its static pages need no automatic meta refresh at all (World Wide Web Consortium Web Accessibility Initiative, 2026c). This does not inspect script- or server-driven changes. The October 7 navigation-name audit closed a false pass in the existing rule: `aria-labelledby` targets on repeated navigation landmarks must now contain text, not merely exist. The October 8 follow-up now rejects the same source-derived name on navigation regions with different link sets while permitting W3C's identical-link-set exception. Focused fixtures cover the empty-target, duplicate-name failure, and exception; all 160 current navigation landmarks pass. Exact source comparisons do not establish label meaning or actual browser and screen-reader announcement (World Wide Web Consortium Web Accessibility Initiative, n.d.-c). The October 9 focus-entry audit found no `autofocus` attribute on any current page. The parser now rejects every occurrence, including `autofocus="false"`, because the HTML Standard processes an eligible candidate by running focusing steps on page load. This strict rule protects the document-entry and bypass path without observing browser focus (WHATWG, 2026). The October 10 automatic-media audit found no `autoplay` attribute on any audio or video element. A focused fixture now rejects both ordinary autoplay and muted `autoplay="false"`. This strict rule follows the HTML Standard's encouragement of user-started playback and W3C's warning that automatic audio can interfere with screen-reader output, but it does not detect script-triggered playback or observe browser behavior (WHATWG, 2026; World Wide Web Consortium Web Accessibility Initiative, n.d.-d). The October 11 document-identity audit found one `html` element with `lang="en"` and one nonempty, unique title on every page, but

the parser could let later roots or titles hide invalid earlier state. It now preserves occurrences and a focused fixture rejects missing or duplicate roots and titles, missing or non-English root language, whitespace-only titles, and an SVG title substituted for the document title. W3C identifies programmatic language and descriptive page titles as Level A requirements; the stricter exactly-one source rule does not assess title meaning or observed announcement (World Wide Web Consortium Web Accessibility Initiative, 2026a, 2026b). The remaining desktop/phone keyboard, reflow, and assistive-technology review now has an explicit 13-page worksheet with 52 results. The verifier derives its sample from current Published summaries and reports and rejects a closed record with placeholders, missing pages, or any non-passing result. The gate remains open because this host has no graphical browser or screen reader; source and worksheet validation do not perform the human review.

The dialog canary is complete. All Projects and the template now use one immutable file per iteration, a bounded 20-link landing page, and complete yearly indexes. The five former DIALOG.md files are preserved byte-for-byte with recorded SHA-256 digests; the verifier checks these hashes, record filename/metadata agreement, and unique index coverage. Scholars read the full charter/state/index, active PI guidance, the three newest records, their own latest record, and older records only when cited or needed. Dr. Jones appends feedback to the record he is answering.

The October 12 embedded-context audit found no iframe on any public page. A focused fixture now accepts nonempty `title`, `aria-label`, and resolvable `aria-labelledby` names while rejecting an absent name, the legacy `name` attribute, and missing or empty referenced labels. W3C's proposed ACT rule maps this condition to Name, Role, Value and says a pass still needs further testing; observed announcement, focus, and embedded-content operation remain in the manual gate (World Wide Web Consortium, n.d.).

The October 13 document-identifier audit found all 328 public `id` attributes nonempty, ASCII-whitespace-free, and unique within their pages. The prior whole-site rule already rejected duplicates but discarded empty IDs and accepted whitespace. One focused fixture now covers all three HTML constraints. This protects fragment and ARIA-reference targets from invalid or ambiguous identifiers without claiming rendered behavior or WCAG conformance (WHATWG, 2026). A supplemental `w3m` pass returned zero for all 26 current 40- and 120-column views and placed “Skip to content” first; it remains no-style text-order evidence.

The October 14 character-encoding audit found that all 39 HTML files decode as UTF-8 and carry one short-form `<meta charset="utf-8">` declaration completed within the first 1024 bytes. One focused fixture rejects undecodable bytes, missing, non-UTF-8, duplicate, legacy `http-equiv`, and late declarations. This converts an implicit parser assumption into a clean whole-site failure without claiming anything about production response headers or observed browser decoding (WHATWG, 2026).

The October 15 document-preamble audit found one leading modern `<!doctype html>` declaration on every public page. A focused fixture accepts the case-insensitive short form after only permitted preamble content and rejects missing, legacy, wrong, duplicate, and late declarations. The HTML Standard requires the doctype and explains that omission tends to trigger an incompatible rendering mode; this source rule does not establish the mode selected by a browser (WHATWG, 2026).

The October 16 start-tag audit found 6,263 attributes across 6,474 start tags without duplicate names. The parser previously collapsed raw attributes into a dictionary before validation, which could hide repeated `id`, `alt`, ARIA, or metadata declarations. It now records names first, and one focused fixture rejects ASCII-case-insensitive duplicates. This narrow rule follows the HTML Standard and protects downstream checks from ambiguous source without claiming general conformance or an observed browser DOM (WHATWG, 2026).

The October 17 document-base audit found no `base` element on any public page, but the verifier resolved paths and fragments against each file without protecting that assumption. The parser now rejects both `base href`, which changes the browser's document base URL, and `base target`, which changes the default navigable for links and forms. One focused fixture covers both forms. This strict static-site rule keeps local-reference and bypass evidence aligned with browser navigation inputs without claiming observed navigation or focus (WHATWG, 2026).

The October 18 ARIA-relationship coverage audit found that missing ID targets could escape the earlier element-specific checks on generic labeled regions. The parser now inventories all eight WAI-ARIA 1.2 ID-reference attributes on every element and rejects an empty attribute or any token without a matching in-document ID. All 19 current attributes resolve their 19 tokens; one focused fixture exercises all eight attributes plus empty and missing failures. This verifies source referential integrity, not semantic correctness or browser accessibility-tree exposure (World Wide Web Consortium, 2023).

The October 19 document-container audit found one explicit `head` followed by one explicit `body` on all 39 pages, with title, encoding, and viewport metadata in head and no source elements or non-whitespace text outside those containers. Earlier checks could validate each declaration without validating its placement. One focused fixture now rejects missing, duplicate, reversed, or nested containers, misplaced metadata, and out-of-container content. This deliberately strict serialization rule follows the HTML Standard's head/metadata and body/content model without claiming an observed browser DOM (WHATWG, 2026).

The October 20 local-resource audit found that HTML `href` and `src` values were checked but resources loaded through CSS `url()` were not. The verifier now parses quoted and unquoted URL functions and CSS escapes while ignoring comments and string literals, then requires each nonempty local dependency to resolve from its stylesheet to an existing

file inside the public tree. All four current dependencies across 23 stylesheets pass. A focused fixture rejects empty, escaping, and missing values while accepting existing, external, embedded, and fragment-only references. CSS resolves relative resource URLs against the stylesheet and treats empty URLs as invalid resources; this source-graph check does not establish general CSS conformance or observed browser loading (World Wide Web Consortium, 2024).

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